

Riccardo Graziani

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Education

2023–present	PhD in Economics , KU Leuven, VIVES Research Centre Fields: political economy, urban economics, economic history – Geospatial datasets from historical maps and travel-cost matrices to study railway and transport networks and regional economic integration
2020–2022	MSc in Economics (Research Advanced Master), UCLouvain Joint degree with Bocconi University
2019–2022	MSc in Economics and Social Sciences , Bocconi University Final grade 107/110. Thesis: <i>The Effect of Socio-cultural Norms on Ethnic Conflicts</i>
2016–2019	BSc in Economics and Social Sciences , Bocconi University Final grade 104/110. Thesis: <i>The Korean Miracle: Economics Explanations in Comparison</i>

Research

Working papers	<i>Who Speaks for the People? Electoral Reforms, Parliamentary Speech, and Legislative Behaviour in Belgium, 1880–1912</i> with Jakob Vanschoonbeek <i>One Reform Divided the Elite, the Other Replaced It: Electoral Reform and Parliamentary Speech in the Belgian Belle Époque, 1880–1912</i> with Jakob Vanschoonbeek <i>Anti-Revolutionary Roads? The Political Effects of Belgium’s Workmen’s Trains</i> with Jakob Vanschoonbeek
Data papers	<i>The Belgian Chamber Debates Dataset: Speeches, Roll-Call Votes and Member Biographies, 1831–2025</i>
Work in progress	<i>Partisanship in Belgian Parliamentary Speech: Evidence from the Chamber of Representatives, 1831–2025</i>

Other research experience

2019–2023	Research Assistant , Harvard Business School for James M. Snyder and Marco Tabellini – Python and Stata pipelines for large-scale historical data construction, using OCR and web scraping – Unsupervised learning and sentiment analysis on large collections of political texts
2020–2023	Research Assistant , University of Rome Tor Vergata for Stefano Gagliarducci – Electoral and administrative data to study the impact of COVID-19 policies on electoral outcomes in Italy – Gravity models estimated with high-dimensional fixed-effects regressions

Skills

Programming	Python, Stata, R, C++, Matlab
Methods	Causal inference (difference-in-differences, instrumental variables), panel data, gravity models, time series; machine learning, natural language processing, text classification, sentiment analysis; web scraping and OCR
Software	LaTeX, ArcGIS, ABBYY FineReader
Languages	Italian (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Spanish (intermediate)